

International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction 2021

ICNR 2021 Preparation Coordination Meeting

Hotel Royal Singhi, Kathmandu, Nepal
2nd November 2021



PANEL

- Mr. **Sushil Gyewali**, CEO, NRA.
- Mr. **Sushil Chandra Tiwari**, Secretary, NRA.
- Dr. **Chandra Bahadur Shrestha**, Executive Committee Member, NRA.

ORGANIZED BY

- ICNR Secretariate
- National Reconstruction Authority (NRA)

SUPPORTED BY

- Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) - Nepal

SUMMARY REPORT ON ICNR PREPARATION COORDINATION MEETING

Hotel Royal Singhi, Kathmandu, Nepal
2 November 2021



SUMMARY

On 2 November 2021, National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) in collaboration with Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) organized an interactive session with I/NGO and Private sector participants with the objective of informing all partners regarding International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction (ICNR) scheduled on 7-9 December 2021 and to ensure their active participation and contribution to ICNR event. The ICNR, an international event is planned by NRA to share Nepal's learning and experiences with national and international communities as its mandated timeframe is approaching to end by December 2021.

In this regard, it has launched official web portal, <https://icnr.nra.gov.np> that is designed to inform every individuals/organization regarding the ICNR event through this website and share important activities pertaining to ICNR event and display reconstruction and recovery products for public consumption. The ICNR Conference Secretariat highly encourages for active participation of all the partners and individuals through proactive [registration](#) through this given link or directly going through the ICNR website as mentioned above.

During the interactive meeting, Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha, Executive Committee Member, and the Convenor of ICNR-2021 Conference Secretariat presented on the ICNR objectives

with ICNR updates. He also highlighted on international contributors for ICNR along with ICNR agenda and issues to sort out pertaining to ICNR preparation, where he stated that I/NGOs and Private sector could contribute to the **Round Table Discussion 3: Reconstruction from I/NGOs and Private Sector for structured session scheduled on 9 December 2021** and requested partners to express their interest for the **marketplace/open session/site visit**. The NRA Secretary, Mr. Sushil Chandra Tiwari expressed that it would be very important to contribute in this ICNR and urged everyone to actively contribute to this ICNR by participating in the event. The CEO closed the interactive meeting by stating that the Nepal's reconstruction has been remarkable and therefore we should feel proud of ourselves. He urged participants to showcase our achievements and learning through this ICNR event collectively and urged everyone to take active participation during the ICNR event and thanked all for participating in the interactive meeting.



KEY HIGHLIGHTS OF THE INTERACTIVE MEETING**Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha, Executive Committee Member, NRA.**[Click here for PPT presentation](#)

Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha shared a brief presentation that shows clarity on objectives of conference, summary of agenda and key issues to be sorted out in terms of ICNR preparation. Dr. Chandra stated that as NRA is in concluding phase and to sum up its so far learned experiences, NRA with an obligation has confirmed to share the learnings, achievements, and way forward through this ICNR event. It is the joint responsibility of partners and stakeholders to showcase the achievements through ICNR while the conference also gives platform to all concerned to disseminate the technologies and advances that were rampantly applied and innovated throughout the reconstruction phase.

The key objectives of the ICNR 2021 are as follows:

- i. Record and disseminate learned lessons and best practices for Nepal's future generation and international community.
- ii. Strengthen relationship between GoN and multilateral agencies, bilateral agencies and Civil Society considering way forward on building resilient Nepal.
- iii. Inform GoN's future disaster related policies and plans.

Dr. Chandra added that through this international conference, NRA aims to say goodbye to all concerned agencies, partners, and stakeholders. In line with the approaching date of its exit from mainstream Nepal's reconstruction, NRA set up ground preparations to inform the involved points of contacts and agencies since December 2019 onwards about NRA's stock taking process, captured the key feedbacks and produced the evidence of its initiatives through its products. Dr. Chandra shared that NRA found immense peace and elevated pride with total of 16 documents that is targeted to present and showcase during ICNR 2021. NRA left no stones unturned on exhibiting its substantial achievements in these circumstances through a publication in International Scientific Document which is under discussion while the achievements were presented in VIKAS Journal of National Planning Commission - Government of Nepal (NPC-GoN) and NRA. Compendium on Nepal's Reconstruction is also in the final stage of production and publication.

Dr. Chandra confirmed that international contributors are the personnel representing major positions in reconstruction and disaster management initiatives. Personnel representing UN Organizations and bilateral donor agencies in Nepal and the individual experts are also

gracing their presence in the conference. Right Honorable Prime Minister of Nepal, Mr. Sher Bahadur Deuba is going to grace the inauguration event as well as closing session. Dr. Chandra emphasized that NRA is preparing to bring two former Prime Ministers of Nepal that were in government from 2015 -2021 to take essence of their leadership experiences in reconstruction interventions.

Summarized ICNR Agenda

07 December 2021	Welcome VVIPs; Site Visit and Welcome Dinner
08 December 2021	Opening Ceremony; Scientific Paper Presentation; Private Housing – Reconstruction Process & Technology; Private Housing – Land Issues; Emergency Response; Heritage; Public Buildings & Infrastructure and Governance & Financial Framework
09 December 2021	Scientific Paper Presentation; Impact Study & Livelihood; Reconstruction from Donor Perspective; Road Map for Resilient Nepal; Reconstruction from NGOs and Private Sector; Reconstruction from Political Lens; Role of Communication and Media and Closing Ceremony
10 December 2021	Targeted field visit for interested international participants

Mr. Sushil Chandra Tiwari, Secretary, NRA

Mr. Tiwari stated that role of large number of I/NGOs has been quite critical in materializing reconstruction support to local communities. Mr. Tiwari stressed that as NRA is in the end of reconstruction phase, therefore post NRA planning process is very important to apply knowledge sharing for addressing future disasters. Mr. Tiwari added that GoN has realized that disaster management is very important aspects and therefore lessons have to be learnt and knowledge transfer process should continue so that future disaster process can be properly addressed. Based on the experiences and learnings shared through the conference, GoN is going to develop roadmap from reconstruction to resilience and requested all partners and individuals for their active participation in the ICNR Event.

Mr. Sushil Gyewali, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), NRA

Mr. Sushil Gyewali in his closing statement stated that whole NRA and the partners associated with NRA should feel proud for reaching out to majority of earthquake affected beneficiaries and earthquake affected communities through local bodies, partners, private sectors, community-based organizations, social groups and communities at large. Mr. Sushil stated that there were many imperfections in NRA while executing its working procedures as business of NRA has undergone many challenges, some of which were- change in NRA leadership couple of times and various structural causes in earthquake affected districts that have delayed the reconstruction

in major urban areas. Mr. Gyewali further added that NRA kept on moving materializing various processes to empower beneficiaries for owner driven shelter reconstruction and channelize local bodies as service providers. There were suggestions received by NRA for facilitating beneficiaries by constructing prefabricated structures by government support while NRA envisioned to bring beneficiaries in frontline by introducing owner driven approach so that they independently take ownership of the whole reconstruction process.

Mr. Gyewali informed participants that NRA has conducted an economic impact study of reconstruction process, and the key findings of which will be informed to the participants, organizations, and citizens at large through the conference. The general findings of impact study have revealed that Nepal's reconstruction has contributed to phenomenal flourishing of construction sector.

Mr. Gyewali proudly shared that the major achievements, learnings, challenges, and way forward will be discussed in the ICNR. Similarly, local government bodies are given platform to share their best practices and learnings so that they can come forward voicing out on behalf of beneficiaries. The interactions in the conference will also address how the sustainability measures can be taken for construction sector that has gained momentum in past 6 years' time.

Mr. Gyewali shared that the latest data of reconstruction progress reveals about 92% houses have accessed 3rd tranche while only 7-8% houses are left to be reconstructed which mainly falls in key urban areas of Nepal. To address the issues related to reconstruction of houses in urban area, NRA has prepared Urban Recovery Strategy Paper. There has been only 52% progress in urban areas while still 48% houses are behind the reconstruction process which is bound to be entangled by many structural causes of land issues and lack of finances. Therefore, to address the remaining 48% that are still to reconstruct houses in urban areas, the conference will discuss over the appropriate financing model also. Mr. Gyewali further stressed that NRA has strategically prepared plans on how to take over the remaining reconstruction works which will be transferred to its successor agencies.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS (Q&A)

Mr. Sanjeev Hada, Habitat for Humanity

Some sort of sharing about their experiences from real community people mainly on how they received the processes and challenges would be excellent to showcase. Are the groups of organizations are coming up with shaping their achievements focusing on reconstruction after 2015 or is there any way out to showcase progresses in multi hazard disasters?

Mr. Kiran Wagle, MottMac/PURNIMA Project

In the process of disengagement and handing over to its successor, how NRA is going to engage Ministries as they are permanent agencies ever after to take learnings further?

Mr. Jimmy Lama, Helambu Education and Livelihood Partnership (HELP), Sindhupalchowk

There is rampant need to bring out the voices from the local communities and local bodies who really indulged in overall reconstruction processes. Similarly, the conferences like this should focus on respecting the resilience of people and inform larger public through key message of why natural hazards happens. There is need of adequate clarity on how marketplace events are going to be distributed to all concerned points.

Ms. Laxmi Shova Shakya, Lakshya Nepal

How to invite those local people, listen to their challenges and learn from their patience? How to facilitate the local masons to come forward to share their experiences in this large forum? How to facilitate the voices of technical staffs to showcase their experiences through this conference?

Mr. Govinda Bahadur Shahi, KIRDARC Nepal

This conference should also focus on bringing ministries, local bodies and real local people who were affected from the earthquake and listen to their voices. The conference need to aware larger public on disaster mapping.

Mr. Manohar Ghimire, Under Secretary, NRA

Various sectors possibly that were involved in Nepal reconstruction process are involved to showcase their work through marketplace events. Private sectors involvement has been crucial in private housing reconstruction processes where beneficiaries have utilized bricks made from local sources.

Mr. Mahendra Bahadur Shrestha, Federation of Nepal Brick Industry

After NRA was established and reconstruction works incepted in many affected districts, CEO of NRA declared that about need of 15 billion number of bricks that will be massively utilized in reconstruction. Nepal Bricks Association took this storm news seriously and were involved in making bricks throughout day and night. Brick industries were increased in a blink of an eye. But this hard work was short lived as now many brick industries are in verge of rampant loss because demand was unprecedentedly less and supply was huge. Brick owners have not been able to raise their investments. Who is going to take charge of this loss?

Mr. Manindra Malla, CARITAS Nepal

The local elected heads of Palikas of affected districts should be invited to hear from their challenges and successes as well to learn from them.

Ms. Amanda Duff, FCDO (Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office), UKAID

How is NRA and its successor going to address the outstanding grievance cases and issues of vulnerable beneficiaries in the process of handing over?

Ms. Tashi Lama, Nepal Red Cross Society

Shelter reconstruction and recovery does not only prove resilience of people. Integrated approach is needed to be highlighted through this conference that contributed to resilience part of the affected people or how should highlight on what are contributing factors to gain resilience. Clear transition plan must be shared to all concerned publicly on transferring the responsibilities of NRA to its successor.

Mr. Keshav Upreti, Kepy Cement Industry

The conference should give clear messages to all concerned to put an end to the haphazard mining in fragile geographic areas of Nepal whereby emphasizing on communicating key preventive and mitigation measures of multi-hazards. Displaced people after major disasters need to be rehabilitated and recovered.

Questions answered by Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha in summary

Market place events has major focus on post-earthquake reconstruction and major interventions taken in the reconstruction processes. Market place allocation is rationalized as well as transparent and is free of cost to all concerned interested organizations however the internal decoration and management cost must be borne by the participating organizations. Allocation is rationalized and transparent.

NRA is serious on involving key Ministries through the conference as well as in the handover process. NRA has already foreseen NDRRMA as its successor and torch bearer agency to give continuity to upcoming tasks of Nepal reconstruction therefore seamless handing over process has already taken with ground preparations from past more than 1 year. One of the sessions on resilience will be chaired by Minister, Ministry of Home Affairs, and another by Chairperson of NPC.

The conference will incorporate few local governments in one round table discussion where they will be sharing their learnings and challenges. Reconstruction most of it in Kathmandu valley were delayed and slow due to many structural causes due to which the motive of making one stop recourse centers on warehouse of construction materials could not be met in timely manner. NRA positively take this criticism and will address in favorable ways.

To achieve meaningful success in addressing outstanding grievances, NRA through the handover process has made CLPIU under the MoUD as perpetual organization to look further into all sort of processes such as grievances redressal, grant approval and building tactics. CLPIU is capacitated enough to structure these all-key processes to facilitate affected beneficiaries that deserves support from GoN.



PARTICIPATION DETAILS

SN	Name	Organization	Designation
1	Sushil Chandra Tiwari	NRA	Joint Secretary
2	Sushil Gyewali	NRA	CEO
3	Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha	NRA	Executive Member
4	Sanjeev Hada	Habitat for Humanity	DRR Advisor
5	Kamala KC	FCDO	Reconstruction and WASH Advisor
6	Amanda Duff	FCDO	Reconstruction Leader
7	Dhruba Gurmachhan	World Vision International	Program Readiness and Integration Manager
8	Andreas Kolling	Build Up Nepal	Manager
9	Manindra malla	Caritas Nepal	Head of Programs
10	Liva Shrestha	Build Change	Lead Engineer
11	Bishnu Aryal	World Education	Senior Program Officer
12	Manohar Ghimire	NRA	Vice Spokesperson
13	Govinda bahadur Shahi	KIRDARC Nepal	Executive Director
14	Bishnu Prasad Subedi	NRA	Under Secretary
15	Madhav Shrestha	Care Nepal	Governance and Accountability Specialist
16	Giri Khatri	Welthungerhilfe	Technical Expert
17	Rajan Shrestha	KAM for Sustainable Development Nepal	Project Coordinator
18	Hiradhar Chudali	Lutheran World Relief	Program Manager
19	Laxmi Shova Shakya	Lakshya Nepal	Team Leader
20	Nabaraj Acharya	Asia Onlus	Program Director
21	Marlco Amandole	Asia Onlus	Asia Onlus
22	Sumitra Adhikari	AATWIN	Treasurer
23	Sarala Maharjan	CAHURAST Nepal	Program Manager
24	Roshan Dahal	Federation Contractor Association of Nepal	General Secretary
25	Mahendra Bahadur Chitrakar	Federation of Nepal Brick Industry	President
26	Kedar Paudel	SAPPROS Nepal	Project Coordinator
27	Tashi Lama	NRCS	M & E Officer
28	Ambika Amatya	HRRP	Reporting Officer
29	Thakur Thapa	Caritas Switzerland	Country Representative
30	Kiran Wagle	Mott Mac, Purnima Project	Team Leader
31	Rahul Pratap Singh	HRRP	Operation Team Lead
32	Bibek Rai	Catholic Relief Services - Nepal	Logistics Assistant

SN	Name	Organization	Designation
34	Saujan Shrestha	Catholic Relief Services - Nepal	ICT Officer
35	Janardhan Nepal	NRA	Administrative Specialist
36	Jimmy Lama	Helambu Education and Livelihood Partnership	Executive Director
37	Ranjana Gautam	Helambu Education and Livelihood Partnership	Program Coordinator
38	Minar Thapa Magar	HRRP	National Coordinator
39	Devi Prasad Panta	Khumbila Samrakshyan Pratisthan	General Secretary
40	Ranjan Dhungel	HRRP	National Technical Coordinator
41	Hari Ram Pathak	HRRP	Province Technical Coordinator
42	Keshab Prasad Upreti	Kepy Cement Industries Private Ltd	Founder Chairperson
43	Surya Narayan Shrestha	NSET	Executive Director
44	Ruplal Aidi	HRRP	Technical Coordinator - GESI
45	Yubraj Bhandari	HRRP	NIMO
46	Sandeep Gurung	NRA	Conference Support
47	Sachin Malego	HRRP - Nepal	NIMO
48	Rijan Gajurel	HRRP	Technical Coordinator-Localization